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Decoding R needs: bridging the gap with university library workshops

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Background

- **Graduate students** expected to be familiar with R
- **Faculty and staff** versed in other languages
- **Transfer and nontraditional students** can slip through the cracks

How to develop a curriculum?

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By looping through trial and error using audience feedback!

First attempt

- Offered a 90-minute introduction to R workshop
- In-person and Zoom versions
- Downloading zipped file from a website, connecting files to an RStudio project, and analyzing the data

Technical literacy

**Familiarity with
coding or R**

Discipline relevance

Challenges

Second attempt

- Two different types of introductory workshops:
 - **No experience:** dives deeper into basics
 - **Some experience coding:** surface-level basics, more complex analyses, graphing, introduction to tidyverse

Successes and next steps

About 24% of survey respondents had no departmental support with R training and also had never taken a workshop at the OSU library - suggesting the library is indeed filling this gap in support for R specifically.

While overall satisfaction is acceptable, there is still plenty of room for improvement - such as creating workshop material with different versions of dataset examples that participants can choose from during the workshop.

Some attendees were undergraduate students, but a significant number were graduate students and faculty. Focusing on further advanced workshops could be useful for those faculty members and graduate students who do not have the time or budget to take a course on campus.

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Thank you!

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